

Outlook

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Follow-up: which card declines become complaints?

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

The same decline code can lead to a successful retry, an ATM attempt, a phone call or lost activity. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if most declines recover immediately?
2. What evidence would instead support that repeat declines cluster by card state or channel?
3. How do we rule out that poor explanations drive complaints more than the decline itself?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use April 2022 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards which decline reasons need rule, message or service changes. A useful output would be a model-ready table, data dictionary and an honest baseline.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: The data does not contain merchant terminal logs or card-scheme dispute outcomes.

Regards